

Experience:

Freelancer / Contractor

UX, UI & Motion Design | Cape Town

April 2023 — Present

I currently work across UX/UI, motion and e-learning, while experimenting with AI-assisted design workflows.

For Laragh Courseware, I create animated e-learning modules using shared illustration systems and After Effects. My work covers storyboarding, visual communication, interaction pacing and animation.

Alongside production work, I've been exploring ways AI and connected design tools can improve the UX process, including functional specifications, rapid prototyping, design systems, tokens and testing.

I'm particularly interested in reducing the distance between a design idea, a working prototype and the final product.

Catch & Release - Agency

Lead UX Designer | Cape Town

February 2022 — April 2023

Catch & Release was the in-house digital agency for rain. I led UX and UI design across the rain website and Android app, while mentoring designers within the agency and rain's internal UX team.

I created and maintained a component-based design system in Figma to improve consistency and make design handoff easier for the development teams.

I also introduced CSS/Lottie SVG animation into the workflow, creating lightweight, resolution-independent interactive animations for both web and Android.

Much of the work involved improving user journeys around new products, promotions and features, working closely with rain's developers and leadership team.

Full Stack - Dev House

Head of UX | Cape Town

March 2017 — Feb 2022

I led and mentored a small team of digital designers and front-end developers, working across digital products for financial services and other large organisations.

My role covered UX, UI, prototyping, front-end development and testing, often taking projects from early stakeholder discussions through to implementation.

Selected work

Sanlam:

Go Cover: UX/UI across web, Android and PWA. I also created HTML email templates and tested them across email clients, browsers and devices.

Concept Bluestar: stakeholder interviews, wireframing, prototyping, front-end development and testing.

Glacier: stakeholder interviews, wireframing, prototyping, front-end development and testing.

PSG:

Website and persona development, wireframing, prototyping and front-end development.

ASISA:

Website analysis, stakeholder interviews, wireframing, prototyping, front-end development, testing and iteration.

Publicis Machine - Agency

Head of UX

Cape Town

June 2015 — May 2016

I was responsible for all digital artefacts relating to UX and UI, persona development, stakeholder interviews, wireframes, clickable prototypes and front-end development.

I also mentored 2 front-end developers. I worked closely with the studio to turn traditional campaign concepts into digital experiences that could actually be built and used.

I worked as part of a full Agile development team, working closely with product owners, developers and project managers from concept through to implementation and iteration.

Some of the brands I worked on are as follows:

- **Sanlam** (*communication campaigns*),
- **Red Bull** (*X-Fighter, communications*),
- **Appletiser** (*intranet full UX process, and front-end development*),
- **Weet-Bix** (*interactive Facebook game*),
- **SASKO** (*Responsive website - front-end development, HTML-email template creation*).

Freelance

Web Designer

Cape Town

April 2012 — June 2015

Much of my work during this period was as a consultant to the Protea Hotels group.

I carried out heuristic evaluations of their website and other customer touchpoints, reviewed available analytics and helped streamline the booking journey.

I also trained their designers and built HTML email templates that could be customised for individual hotels while remaining consistent across different email clients. The templates were designed so that content could be changed without breaking the underlying markup.

Global Vision

Lead Designer / Front-End Developer | Cape Town

Cape Town

Oct 2007 — April 2012

I led a small team working across intranets, websites, management information systems and business applications.

One of the more unusual projects was a Flash-based interactive experience for Bushmills whiskey. It featured a panoramic Irish landscape centred around the Giant's Causeway and distillery. Users could explore the environment, discover stories about the distillers and learn about the triple-distillation process.

More importantly for my career, this was where I worked with UX specialist Phil Barrett on an internal CRM platform we were developing as a SaaS product in Silverlight.

That experience changed how I thought about design. Until then, I had mainly thought about how things looked and worked. I started paying much more attention to how people understood and interacted with them.

Laragh Courseware - E-Learning

Graphic Designer | Cape Town

Oct 2002 — Sep 2007

Laragh created interactive e-learning materials. I designed guided software simulations using Macromedia Director and Adobe Flash.

Working on these simulations was one of the first times I started thinking seriously about UX. I noticed that software wasn't necessarily intuitive just because it worked, and began paying more attention to what the person using it actually understood.

Page Arts - Home Based Business

Graphic/Print Designer

Cape Town

Feb 2001 — Sep 2002

Page Arts (DTP) business that did print layouts for institutions like UCT's lecture materials, the Western Cape Government Statute books, as well as layouts for independent authors. I was responsible for image retouching, deep-etching and prepping files for print, and some page layouts.

Yes Xpress

Graphic & Print Designer

Cape Town, Cavendish and Blue Route Tokai, branches

Apr 1998 — Jun 2001

I worked in the document services. Specialising in high-quality signage, photocopies, and brochure print design. This was my first real job as a print designer. I was also responsible for a walk in graphic design service (being situated in malls).

McCann Erickson - Agency

Graphic Design Intern

Johannesburg

Apr 1996 — Jun 1997

After completing my Graphic Design training at Hirt & Carter, I secured an internship at McCann Erickson. In this role, I applied my newly acquired skills in Photoshop and FreeHand in a fast-paced, live production environment. I primarily worked on the Pick n Pay (PnP) account, handling deep-etching, retouching of product photography, and preparing assets for print campaigns.

Paul Bristow-Bovey

Senior UX/UI, Interaction & Systems Designer

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Education

Extended Reality (XR) UX Design

Udemy | 2026

Exploring interaction beyond screens, including gestures, spatial interaction and physical comfort.

UX South Africa Conference

A yearly conference that delved into the latest UX trends, how they are being adapted and what experts in the community are doing to improve on user centered design.

| 2015/16/17

UX Design Best Practices

Flow / Phil Barrett | 2012

Affinity mapping, personas, scenarios, journey mapping, storyboarding and heuristic evaluation.

Concept Interactive

| 2002

Animation, sound intergration, ActionSript 3, Lingo

Mac KnowHow

| 2009

Advanced Photoshop course

Hirt & Carter

| 1995

Advanced Photoshop course

Cape Town High School

High School | 1994

- Matriculated with exception
- Prefect